

Evrin Bilgen

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Professional Summary

Technical Product Manager specializing in search, document intelligence, and LLM-powered products, with a decade shipping systems at real scale: RAG and retrieval across 2M+ documents, search relevance work that cut P95 latency 18% and zero-result queries 34%, and a CRM/billing platform serving 38M users. Five years as a software engineer before moving into product, and still works at that level of detail. Sits between engineering teams and the enterprise clients, analysts, and compliance functions who depend on what they ship, translating in both directions. Leads cross-functional teams of 10 to 50+ across fintech, telecom, and B2B SaaS.

Experience

Fractional TPM Consultant, Self-Employed

Remote

AI product work with B2B SaaS and early-stage teams, from discovery through production

Aug 2025 – Present

- Enterprise analysts were losing hours navigating disconnected PDF libraries with no way to query across them. Leading the build of an agentic RAG research assistant that decomposes complex queries into search, retrieval, and synthesis steps and answers with citations pulled directly from internal documents. Delivered MVP to 3 clients; now supports 500K+ documents and shapes the roadmap for a Series A startup.
- API clients were losing days to manual SDK updates, causing version drift across libraries. Shipped an LLM-powered tool that auto-generates and maintains Python, TypeScript, and Java SDKs directly from OpenAPI specs, cutting update cycles from 2-3 days to under 4 hours and enabling 2 B2B clients to ship 5x faster across 12+ endpoints.

ISI Emerging Markets / EMIS, Senior Product Manager

Warsaw, Poland

a B2B SaaS platform for financial and industry research across emerging markets

Aug 2022 – Aug 2025

- APAC users were waiting up to 5 seconds per query, long enough to abandon the tool entirely, and 30% of churned trials named search as the reason. The easy fix would have been to add more caching. Instead, pulled the query logs first, ran behavioral clustering to find where the long tail actually broke, then went after Elasticsearch, caching, and pagination in that order. P95 latency dropped 18%, zero-result queries fell 34%, and trial-to-paid conversion moved from 8.5% to 9.5%.
- The platform's 2M+ PDF reports were a black box, no way to query across them, which put a hard ceiling on how deep analysts could go. Made the case for an AI-assisted research layer, then led the team through it: natural language queries across the full library. Analyst research time dropped 40%, power-user retention rose 23% within six months.
- Undocumented, inconsistent APIs were blocking new client expansion, stretching integration cycles to 6 weeks. Worked directly with client integration teams to find where they were actually getting stuck, then drove an API refactoring initiative using OpenAPI standards to establish clear contracts and self-service documentation. Integration time dropped from 6 weeks to 10 days and 40+ enterprise clients adopted the platform.
- Without a shared data foundation, roadmap decisions defaulted to whichever feature request was loudest. Defined platform-level KPIs (query success rate, time-to-insight, engagement depth), shipped real-time dashboards, and moved a 10-15 person cross-functional team from opinion-driven to data-driven prioritization.

BR-AG (now Regnology), Senior Product Manager

Poznan, Poland

a global FinTech platform specializing in regulatory reporting for financial institutions and regulators

Feb 2022 – Aug 2022

- Regulatory submissions (COREP, FINREP) were failing validation at high rates, putting clients at SLA risk ahead of every reporting cycle. Redesigned the platform's data contracts to standardize submission formats and delivered ML-based risk flagging to catch errors before they reached regulators, sharply reducing validation failures and accelerating submission cycles.
- Compliance teams were fully dependent on engineering for any data query, creating bottlenecks before every regulatory deadline. Sat with both sides to separate what compliance actually needed from what engineering was being asked to build, then delivered self-service SQL tooling that let compliance analysts run their own reports. Engineering request volume dropped and both teams moved faster on deadline-critical work.

MIRA, Senior Product Manager

WA, USA

an AI startup delivering behavioral scoring products for iGaming clients

Mar 2020 – Nov 2021

- iGaming clients had no way to predict which trial users would convert or churn, leaving retention to chance. Owned the ML-based user scoring product, building behavior-driven propensity models that surfaced high-risk users before they left. Trial-to-paid conversion improved materially and churn dropped within the first quarter of deployment.
- This was a 0-to-1 product with direct monetization impact: the scoring model existed only as a concept, and the 12-person team had no shared view of what success looked like. Shipped the predictive scoring microservice (FastAPI, Kubernetes) from scratch, validated results through A/B testing, and established OKRs connecting scoring outcomes directly to trial-to-paid conversion.

Turkcell Group, Senior Product Manager

Turkey's largest telecom operator

Istanbul, Turkey

Oct 2017 – Nov 2019

- The CRM/billing platform serving 38M subscribers was a monolith: deployments took over 4 hours, outages were unpredictable, and any change carried system-wide risk. Led a cross-functional team of 50+ through a microservices transformation starting with the Customer Profile service, introducing CI/CD pipelines and observability via ELK and Grafana. Deployment time dropped from 4+ hours to under 30 minutes, peak-load incidents fell 60%, and feature release cycles shortened from 6+ weeks to 2-3 weeks per service.
- Campaign targeting for millions of active users was taking days, making real-time personalization impossible at scale. Led the delivery of an ML-powered customer segmentation engine with engineering and data teams, and established OpenAPI contracts and OKRs across cross-functional teams, cutting targeting cycles from days to hours and improving API consistency across integration teams.

Allianz, Senior Product Owner

a global insurance company

Istanbul, Turkey

Sep 2015 – Oct 2017

- Web access existed but there was no mobile app, leaving a growing segment of mobile-first policyholders without a convenient channel for claims and policy management. Led a 20+ person cross-functional team to take a mobile-first health insurance platform from 0 to 1, running Figma-driven discovery sessions with the claims team and customers to prioritize claim submission, doctor search, and policy overview as core MVP features. Reached 65% mobile adoption within 6 months, significantly reducing call center load.
- Legacy policy systems had no API layer, blocking real-time data access for the new mobile platform. Drove OAuth2-secured API integrations connecting mobile to core policy systems, enabling real-time policy lookup and materially cutting claim processing time.

Logo Business, Senior Software Analyst Developer

a leading ERP and business software company in Turkey

Istanbul, Turkey

Oct 2013 – Sep 2015

- Built SaaS e-invoice modules (ASP.NET, C#) for enterprise clients, streamlining invoice processing and enabling integration across multiple ERP systems.

Axa Insurance, Software Developer

a global insurance and financial services company

Istanbul, Turkey

Oct 2010 – Oct 2013

- Developed enterprise financial reporting systems (ASP.NET, PL/SQL, T-SQL), automating monthly reports and significantly improving operational efficiency across finance teams.

Education

University of Warsaw, MSc in Data Science and Business Analytics

Jan 2020 – Jan 2023

Maltepe University, BSc in Mathematics and Computer Programming

Jan 2003 – Jan 2007

Courses

AWS, Certified Cloud Practitioner

Professional Scrum, Product Owner I (PSPO I)

Google, UX Design Certificate

Skills

Search & Information Retrieval: Elasticsearch, Search Relevance & Ranking, Query Understanding, Long-Tail & Zero-Result Analysis, Semantic Search, Vector Search & Embeddings

Document Intelligence & LLM Products: RAG, Retrieval over Large Document Corpora, Citation & Grounding, LLMs, Prompt Engineering, RAG Evaluation, LangChain, Hugging Face, Langfuse, RAGAS, Cursor, Claude

Data & Machine Learning: Python, SQL, Data Modeling, Behavioral Clustering, Predictive Scoring, A/B Testing, Experiment Design

Platform Engineering & APIs: API Design & Versioning, OpenAPI / Schema-Driven Development, SDK Strategy & Automation, API & SDK Usability, Microservices Architecture, Backward Compatibility, FastAPI, Platform Product Management

Product Management & Discovery: Product Strategy, AI Product Lifecycle, RICE Prioritization, KPIs, OKRs, Stakeholder Management, User Research & Discovery, Prototyping (Figma), FullStory, Developer Experience (DevEx), Agile / Scrum / Kanban

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (Lambda, S3, IAM), Kubernetes, Docker, Observability (ELK, Grafana), CI/CD (Jenkins, GitLab)

Languages

English (C1) | Turkish (Native speaker)